November 2025

# NATHAN FRANZ


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US Citizen


## EDUCATION

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| Ph.D. | Department of Economics, University of Texas at Austin,<br>Committee: Dean Spears (chair), Mike Geruso, Sandra Black, Diane Coffey | expected 2026 |
| M.A. | Department of Economics, University of Texas at Austin | 2020 |
| B.S. | Department of Mathematics and Department of Physics and Astronomy<br>University of Wisconsin Oshkosh | 2017 |

## RESEARCH

### Working papers

Franz, N. (**Job market paper.)** Cheaper and better? Explaining a newborn mortality advantage at public versus private hospitals in India.

Vyas, S., & Franz, N. Be careful what you ask for: social desirability bias in self-reported data in India.

Franz, N., Gupta, A., Spears, D., & Coffey, D. Uncertainty about maternal mortality in India: New, higher estimates from the National Family Health Survey-4. Revision requested: *Population Studies*.

### Peer-reviewed journal articles

Coffey, D., Srivastav, N., Priya, A., Verma, A., Franz, N., Kumar, A., & Spears, D (2025). Excess neonatal mortality among private facility births in rural parts of high-mortality states of India: Demographic analysis of a national survey. *Social Science and Medicine*, *379*, 118158.

Smita, Franz, N., & Coffey, D. (2024). The association between cesarean birth and breastfeeding initiation in Odisha, India: A mother fixed effects analysis. *PLOS One*, *19*(2), e0287796.

Arenberg, S., Kuruc, K., Franz, N., Vyas, S., Lawson, N., LoPalo, M., Budolfson, M., Geruso, M., & Spears, D. (2022). Intergenerational transmission is not sufficient for positive long-term population growth. *Demography*, *59*(6), 2003-2012.

Franz, N., & Spears, D. (2020). Mere Addition is equivalent to avoiding the Sadistic Conclusion in all plausible variable-population social orderings. *Economics Letters*, *196*, 109547.

Other publications

Coffey, D., Franz, N., Arenberg, S., Xu, M., & Vyas, S. (2022). Annual Health Survey (AHS), India, 2007–2012. Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research.

Spears, D., Franz, N., & Coffey, D. (2021). What can we learn about the Swachh Bharat Mission from the NFHS-5 fact sheets? *Ideas for India*, 2 February.

## TEACHING

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| Spring 2025 | Instructor of record for ECO 304K—Introduction to Microeconomics |
| Spring 2024 | Teaching assistant for<br>SOC 391L— Basic Demographic Methods and Materials<br>(core course in the graduate Demography training sequence) |
| Fall 2022 | Teaching assistant for<br>SOC 391L— Basic Demographic Methods and Materials |
| Fall 2022 | Teaching assistant, including giving a lecture, for<br>ECO 333L— Development and Population |
| Spring 2022 | Teaching assistant for ECO 441K—Introduction to Econometrics |
| Fall 2021 | Teaching assistant for ECO 441K—Introduction to Econometrics |
| Fall 2020 | Helped create new course materials and served as teaching assistant for<br>SOC 591L— Basic Demographic Methods and Materials |

## INVITED PRESENTATIONS

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| 2025, Nov | Northeast Universities Development Consortium<br>Hunter College<br>Clark University<br>North Texas Economics Conference |
| 2025, Jun | American Society of Health Economists Conference |
| 2025, May | Rosenkranz Global Health Symposium |
| 2025, Apr | Population Association of America Annual Conference (poster and presentation)<br>Texas Applied Microeconomics Student Workshop |
| 2024, Apr | Southern Economics Association Annual Conference |
| 2024, Apr | Population Association of America Annual Conference (poster),<br>Texas Applied Microeconomics Student Workshop |
| 2023, Apr | Population Association of America Annual Conference (poster),<br>Texas Applied Microeconomics Student Workshop |

## External review

Referee for *Social Choice and Welfare* and *The Indian Economic Journal*.

## Awards and fellowships

2025, Nov Winner, Best Graduate Student Paper, North Texas Economics Conference
2024, Summer Dissertation Writing Fellowship, UT Graduate School—$8,500

## Professional experience

2023– Research assistant for Dean Spears and Mike Geruso
2024– Economics Department representative for College of Liberal Arts Graduate Student Advisory Council
2023– Representative for Economics Graduate Student Association
2020–2021 Research assistant, Population Research Center, University of Texas at Austin.
2017–2019 Research analyst, then scientist. Dynetics, Inc. Huntsville, Alabama.